

file you want to flash. An ISA video card is preferable, but if you do not have one, you can still do it. If you have the ISA card then you will be able to see what you are doing. Reboot the system to the DOS prompt and repeat the steps outlined above for flashing, or the steps specified by your motherboard manufacturer.

If you don't have an ISA video card, create an `autoexec.bat` file, which will run when you boot into the DOS system. Use Notepad to create a single line entry which will contain the flash program name followed by the update file name along with any switches that are specified. For example, the following line should be in the `autoexec.bat` file to flash an Award BIOS:

```
a: awd802.exe backup.bin /py /Sb /sn /cc /cp /cd /R.
```

This instructs the DOS system to run `autoexec.bat` when the system boots up and run the `awd802.exe` flash program using the `backup.bin` BIOS update file. The switches are various options specific to the flash program, with the last switch instructing the program to reboot once flashing is completed.

Copy the `autoexec.bat` file to the floppy with your flash program and the BIOS update file you want to use. The floppy should only contain the basic DOS system files, and should not have any other files (such as `config.sys`) that may auto-load on start up and interfere with the flashing.

The example above is for an Award BIOS update. While the parameters will most likely differ for your particular BIOS version, the general approach remains the same:

- Create a DOS system floppy
- Copy the flash program and the BIOS update file
- Create an `autoexec.bat` batch file with a single line entry instructing DOS to flash the BIOS when the system starts up

Be sure to read up the manufacturer's instructions on each switch parameter and how they should be used.